

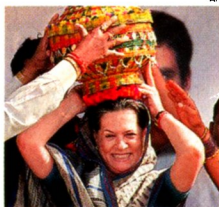


Cover story

PHOTO FEATURE

Head TO HEAD

- Sonia Gandhi's crowning glory was a historic mandate for the Congress. Jaswant Singh shifted base from Rajasthan and traded the pagdi for an assortment of hill headgear. Hema Malini crisscrossed the country striking pretty poses.



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● IT'S SHOE BIZ

Journalist Jarnail Singh set off a trend of flinging footwear on politicians. He missed P. Chidambaram in Delhi but voters caught up with the minister in Sivaganga.



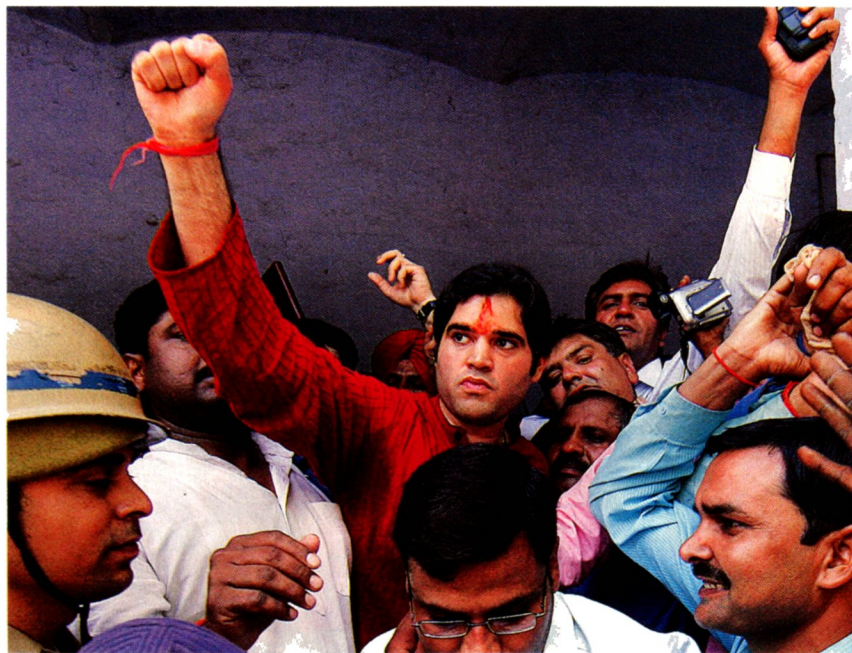
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● UNITED THEY FELL

"We have lost one ally but have got five," said L.K. Advani at a Ludhiana rally where Nitish Kumar and Narendra Modi shared the dais. The ally lost was BJD's Naveen Patnaik and the allies won were five. It wasn't enough.



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REUTERS

● THE POLITICS OF HATE

The BJP didn't know whether to love him or hate him, but Varun Gandhi spewed enough venom to win from Pilibhit. Varun *nahin aandhi hai, doosra Sanjay Gandhi hai*, said his supporters as Mayawati's bete noire spent 20 days in jail eating slimming food as punishment for his excesses. He insisted though that he had never said the hateful words.